

COURSE SYLLABUSFall 2026

The American Designed Landscape since 1850 (3 units)

This course surveys the history of American designed landscapes since 1850 including the rise of the public parks movement, the development of park systems, the establishment of the national parks, the landscape of the Progressive Era, suburbs, environmental planning, land art, and the modernist landscape. This encompasses public open spaces, conservation areas, city design, landscape planning, and gardens. The course emphasizes the cultural, political, and social contexts which have shaped and informed American landscapes since the advent of the public park movement, as well as the aesthetic precepts, environmental concerns, horticultural practices, and innovations of American landscapes.

Lecture outlines with relevant terms, sites, and site plans, and the readings are available for each lecture topic on bCourses. Students will complete a midterm, final, and a research assignment. Class will be synchronous and in-person unless conditions warrant a change.

While the lectures will be zoomed, recorded, and posted on bCourses, these are a backup. In person class attendance is required unless an excused absence is warranted.

Class times Tuesdays and Thursdays, 3:30-5:00pm
Room 101 Bauer Wurster Hall

Required reading On bCourses

Grading Midterm Exam 35% - in class in person hand written bluebook
Research Assignment 25%
Final Exam 40% - in class in person hand written bluebook
Required in person class attendance, 1 unexcused absence max

Contact Info Professor Louise Mozingo
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Course Communication through bCourse and bCourse Announcements

The American Designed Landscape Since 1850
Schedule and Readings

Good notetaking, is essential for this course. The Lecture outline term lists available on bCourse forms a basic outline for your notetaking. Digital notetaking is allowed, but unless part of a DSP accommodation written notetaking is highly recommended and preferable—see [this study](#) that makes this clear. If taking notes in this course is challenging, please meet with the GSI in office hours for guidance.

NOTE: * denotes material not covered in class but required for exams
Readings may be added at the discretion of instructor.**

Week 1 Aug 27 Course Overview; the United States in 1850

Dianne Harris. "What History Should We Teach and Why? An Historian's Response." *Landscape Journal*, 16:2, Fall 1997

Mount Pleasant, Jane. "The Paradox of Plows and Productivity: An Agronomic Comparison of Cereal Grain Production under Iroquois Hoe Culture and European Plow Culture in the Seventeenth and Eighteenth Centuries." *Agricultural History*, Vol. 85, No. 4 (Fall 2011), pp. 460-492.

Jones Allen, Diane. "Living Freedom Through the Maroon Landscape." *Places Journal*. September, 2022.

Week 2 Sep 1 & Sep 3 Downing and Olmsted; Central Park

Downing, Andrew Jackson. Excerpts from "Beauties and Principles of the Art" from *The Theory and Practice of Landscape Gardening Adapted to North America* originally published 1841 and reprinted in *Landscape Gardening and Rural Architecture*. New York: Dover Publications, 1991. 56-65.

Schuyler, David. "Toward a Redefinition of Urban Form and Culture" from *The New Urban Landscape: The Redefinition of City Form in Nineteenth Century America*. Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1986. 24-36.

Week 3 Sep 8 & Sep 10 Public Parks

Rosenzweig, Roy and Elizabeth Blackmar. *The Park and The People: A History of Central Park*. Ithaca, N.Y.: Cornell University Press, 1992. 238-259, 307-339.

Week 4 Sep 15 & Sep 16 Park Systems

Schuyler, David. "Parks, Parkways, and Park Systems" from *The New Urban Landscape: The Redefinition of City Form in Nineteenth Century America*. Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1986. 126-147.

Week 5 Sep 22 & Sep 24 **National Lands**

Research topic uploaded onto bCourse by 6pm Friday, Sep 25, 2026

Keller, Robert H. and Michael F. Turek. "From Yosemite to Zuni: Parks and Native Peoples" from *American Indians & National Parks*. Tucson: University of Arizona Press, 1998. 13-29, 249-252.

Smith, Michael B. "The Value of a Tree: Public Debates of John Muir and Gifford Pinchot." *The Historian*. 60, Summer, 1998, 757-778.

Nash, Roderick. "The Wilderness Cult" from *Wilderness and the American Mind*. New Haven: Yale University Press, 1982. 141-160.

Week 6 Sep 29 & Oct 1 **National Lands; Nineteenth-Century Suburbs**

Required RESEARCH SESSION with CED Librarian Andrew Matsas TBA

Cronon, William. "Learning to Do Historical Research: Sources How to Read a Landscape."

<https://www.williamcronon.net/researching/landscapes.htm>

Schuyler, David. "Urban Decentralization and the Urban Landscape" from *The New Urban Landscape: The Redefinition of City Form in Nineteenth Century America*. 1986. 149-166.

Week 7 Oct 6 & Oct 8 **City Beautiful; Neighborhood Parks & Playgrounds**

Required RESEARCH SESSION with CED Librarian Andrew Matsas TBA

Barlow, Elizabeth Rogers. "II. The City Beautiful: Monumental Urbanism in Beaux Arts America." "III. America the Beautiful" and from *Landscape Design: A Cultural and Architectural History*. New York: Harry N. Abrams, 2001. 368-373.

Excerpts from *A Breath of Fresh Air: Chicago's Neighborhood Parks of the Progressive Era, 1900-1925*. Chicago: Chicago Public Library and the Chicago Park District, 1989.

Olmsted, Frederick Law, Jr. and John Nolen. "The Normal Requirements of American Towns and Cities in Respect to Public Open Spaces." *Charity and the Commons*. July 7, 1906. 411-426.

Week 8 Oct 13 & Oct 15 **Jens Jensen; MIDTERM**

MIDTERM THURSDAY 10/15/26 IN CLASS

Egan, Dave and William H. Tishler. "Jens Jensen, Native Plants, and the Concept of Nordic Superiority." *Landscape Journal*. Vol. 18, No. 1. 11-29.

Lawson, Laura. "The Planner in the Garden: A Historical View into the Relationship between Planning and Community Gardens." *Journal of Planning History*. 3:2, May 2004, 151-176.***

Week 9 Oct 20 & Oct 22 Garden Cities & Reform Housing; State Parks (reading only)

Barlow, Elizabeth Rogers. "II. Greenbelt Towns or Suburbs" from *Landscape Design: A Cultural and Architectural History*. New York: Harry N. Abrams, 2001. 417-422.

Newton, Norman. "XXXVII. The State Parks Movement: 1864-1933" from *Design on the Land: The Development of Landscape Architecture*. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press, 1971. 555-575. ***

O'Brien, William E. "State Parks and Jim Crow in the Decade Before Brown V. Board of Education." *Geographical Review*. April 2012, vol. 102, no. 2. pp. 166-179***

Week 10 Oct 27 & Oct 29 Eclectic Estate Gardens and the Country Place Era; Mission Revival & the California Garden

**Research assignment PROGRESS REPORT and ANNOTATED BIBLIOGRAPHY
uploaded onto bCourse by 6pm Friday Oct 30, 2026**

Barlow, Elizabeth Rogers. "Landscape and Cityscape as Aesthetic Experience: The Arts and Crafts Movement and the Revival of the Formal Garden" and "Design Synthesis: The End of the American Country Place Era" from *Landscape Design: A Cultural and Architectural History*. New York: Harry N. Abrams, 2001. 375-6, 393-401.

Elizabeth Kryder-Reid, "Cultivating Heritage: Race, Identity, and the Politics of the Mission Landscape," in *California Mission Landscapes: Race, Memory, and the Politics of Heritage*, 2016.

Week 11 Nov 3 & Nov 5 New Deal & WW II; Modernist Design

Newton, Norman. "XXXVIII. The State Parks and the Civilian Conservation Corps." *Design on the Land: The Development of Landscape Architecture*. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press, 1971. 576-595. ***

Jewell, Linda. "Great Siteworks." *Places*. 10:3, 64-71.***

Cutler, Pheobe. "On Recognizing a WPA Rose Garden or a CCC Privy." *Landscape*. 20:2, Winter 1976, 3-9.***

Helphand, Kenneth. "Stone Gardens; Japanese American Internment Camps, 1942-45" from *Defiant Gardens: Making Gardens in Wartime*. San Antonio: Trinity University Press, 2006. 155-200. ***

Treib, Marc. "Axioms for a Modern Landscape Architecture" from *Modern Landscape Architecture: A Critical Review*. Marc Treib, ed. Cambridge: The MIT Press, 1993. 36-67.

Week 12 Nov 10 & Nov 12 Modernist Design

Davis, Timothy. "The American Motor Parkway." *Studies in the History of Gardens & Designed Landscapes*. 25: 4, October/December 2005, 219-49.***

Caro, Robert. "One Mile" and "One Mile (Afterward)" from *The Power Broker: Robert Moses and the Fall of New York*. New York: Alfred A. Knopf, 1974. 851-894.

Week 13 Nov 17 & Nov 19 **1960s Urban Landscape: housing, highways, and highrises; Suburban Corporate Landscapes**

Mozingo, Louise A. "Campus, Estate, and Park: Lawn Culture Comes to the Corporation." from *Everyday America: Cultural Landscape Studies after J. B. Jackson*. Chris Wilson and Paul Groth, eds. Berkeley: University of California Press, 2003. 255-274.

Mozingo, Louise A. "The Corporate Estate in the USA, 1954-64: "Thoroughly modern in concept...yet down to earth and rugged." *Studies in the History of Gardens and Designed Landscapes*. 20:1, Jan-Mar 2000, 25-56.

Week 14 Nov 24 & Nov 26 **Environmental Planning; THANKSGIVING**

RESEARCH ASSIGNMENT uploaded to bCourse 12noon Wednesday, Nov 25, 2026

Steiner, Frederick, Gerald Young and Ervin Zube. "Ecological Planning: Retrospect and Prospect." *Landscape Journal*. 4:2, Spring 1988, 31-9.
Steinitz, Carl. "Landscape planning: a history of influential ideas." *Landscape Architecture*. 99:2. 2009 Feb. 2009, 74, 76-80, 82-83.

Week 15 Dec 1 & Dec 3 **Land Art; Post-Modernist Landscapes**

Beardsley, John. "Monument and the Environment: The Avant Garde, 1966-1976" from *Earthworks and Beyond: Contemporary Art in the Landscape*. New York: Abbeville Press, 1984. 13-40.
Laurie Olin. "Form, Meaning and Expression in Landscape Architecture." *Landscape Journal*. 7:2, Fall 1988, 149-168.

Week 16 Dec 7 - Dec 11 **RRR Week – Review TBA**

Final Exam: Friday DEC 18, 2022 7:00pm–10:00pm PST
(Yes, this is the very last exam slot – we will talk)

The Berkeley Honor Code

The student community at UC Berkeley has adopted the following Honor Code:
"As a member of the UC Berkeley community, I act with honesty, integrity, and respect for others." The expectation is that you will adhere to this code. For more detailed information see: <https://conduct.berkeley.edu/integrity/>

Use of AI

This course allows limited uses of GenAI tools but also prohibits broad use of them in cases that would be considered plagiaristic if the tool's output had been composed by a human author.

Permitted uses of AI:

- It may be used to perform research in ways similar to search engines such as Google, and for other functions attendant to completing an assignment.
- It may be used as a writing assistant in its capacity as a word processor, such as Word or Pages, i.e., for correcting grammar and spelling, and other functions like synonym suggestion.
- It may be used as translation software for consultation purposes; you must cite the translation software as you would a human translator
- All use of AI must be cited in the research paper.

Prohibited uses of AI:

- The use of GenAI tools such as ChatGPT or equivalent should not be used to summarize, generate, or interpret any thoughts or text present in any of your work. **The software may not be used to compose any part of the research paper assignment.**
- GenAI should never be employed for a use that would constitute plagiarism if the GenAI source were a human or organizational author.
- Having another person/entity do the writing of any substantive portion of an assignment for you is against academic integrity policies, and can include hiring a person or a company to write essays and drafts and/or other assignments, research-based or otherwise, and using GenAI tools.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

We are committed to creating a learning environment that meets the needs of its diverse student body including students with disabilities. If you anticipate or experience any barriers to learning in this course, please feel welcome to discuss your concerns with Professor Louise Mzingo or GSI Shrabya Timesina. If you have a disability, or think you may have a disability, you can work with the Disabled Students' Program (DSP) to determine any accommodations you may need to have equal access in this course. The Disabled Students' Program (DSP) is the campus office responsible for authorizing disability-related academic accommodations, in cooperation with the students themselves and their instructors. You can find more information about the DSP application process <https://dsp.berkeley.edu/home>. Professor Mzingo is available if you have any questions or concerns about your accommodations. In the event of a disagreement, the proper procedure is for you to work with your DSP Specialist and, in turn, your DSP Specialist to work with me toward a resolution.

Cheating and Plagiarism

Anyone cheating or plagiarizing in this course will be reported to the University Center for Student Conduct. Improper use of AI is cheating. AI use should be limited to grammar and

spelling checks, or other minor supporting roles, and citation of the AI program and specification of how it has been must be included in the research assignment. See <https://writing.berkeley.edu/academic-honesty>

If University Center for Student Conduct process determines that cheating or plagiarizing has taken place the student will receive an “F” grade for the course, without exception. To copy text or ideas from another source without appropriate reference is plagiarism and will result in a failing grade in the course and further disciplinary action. For additional information on plagiarism and how to avoid it, see:

<https://guides.library.ucla.edu/citing/plagiarism/avoid>

COVID-19 and other illnesses

Please follow all campus guidelines for COVID safety provided by campus for students <https://uhs.berkeley.edu/coronavirus-covid-19-information> . If you need to miss class due to COVID or any other illness, please take care of your health first, but then do contact the instructor or GSI about missing class to make accommodations and ensure you do not fall behind. *Not attending class because of illness is an excused absence but you must inform the instructors as soon as possible that you will miss class.*